CSC662 mock paper - review checklist

Paper: mock_paper_01.pdf (5 pages). **Scheme:** mock_scheme_01.pdf (5 pages). **Computed:** 6 slots / 28 marks. **Placeholders:** 18 slots / 72 marks.

> **THEORY QUESTIONS ARE PLACEHOLDERS.** The theory module has not been built. Do not treat the 72 placeholder marks as a complete exam. The paper is a practice-mode paper with 28 computed marks (7x the clean-modern average of ~4 marks/paper).

1. Does the layout look like a real CSC662 paper?

[ ] Yes [ ] No Comments:

- Parts/marks: Part A 10 x (2+6) = 80; Part B 2 x (5+5) = 20; total 100; 3 hours. Matches JUN/DEC 2019 and FEB 2022.
- Header/footer on every body page: yes - CONFIDENTIAL, page number, CS/MOCK OCT 2026/CSC662, copyright.
- a)/b) numbering and right-aligned (N marks): yes.
- **Part headings with mark totals: no** - mock says PART A / PART B; modern papers say PART A (80 MARKS) / PART B (20 MARKS).
- **Cover:** mock uses FINAL EXAMINATION + 5 instructions (FEB 2026 template); FEB 2022 uses FINAL TEST + 3 instructions + Name/ID/Group + marks grid. No name grid in the mock.
- **Density:** 5 pages, 4 questions/page on pages 2-4 (Part B Q2 tail on p5); modern papers 6/7/14 pages, FEB 2022 one question/page. Less answer space.
- Headings: mock 10.7 pt regular; FEB 2022 11 pt bold; DEC 2019 ~10 pt regular.

2. Do the computed questions look like ones this course would set?

- Caesar/Playfair/columnar/ACM are course types; lengths and marks are the concern.
- **Caesar Q2a/Q4a:** 24-25 letters, shift 7, 2 marks. Real modern Caesar: 11 letters, 6 marks, identify key; older: 15 letters, 3 marks.
- **Playfair Q2b/Q4b:** 12-13 pairs, key REDFOX, 6 marks. Real Playfair: 10 letters, 5 pairs, 6 marks.
- **ACM Q3b:** matrix + ACL + CL + diagram, 6 marks. Older course: 3+3+3 = 9 marks for the three views; modern: matrix only, 6 marks.
- **Columnar Q5b:** 3x4 grid, 12 letters, 6 marks. The 3x4 fill-rows/read-columns/pad-X convention is **verified** against lecture slides 20-21/24. Real columnar: 30 letters, pad D/z, "Show the steps"; 6/8 marks.
- [ ] The computed questions look like course questions [ ] Too long / too short [ ] Marks too tight / too generous

3. Conventions to confirm

- **Playfair (no lecture slide):** [ ] I/J merge [ ] separate J [ ] X padding [ ] other padding: _____
- **Columnar 3x4 (slides 20-21/24: 3 rows x 4 columns, fill rows, read columns, pad X):** [ ] confirmed [ ] different: rows ___ cols ___; fill [ ] rows [ ] columns; read [ ] rows [ ] columns; pad [ ] X [ ] Z [ ] none
- **Vigenere (slide 15: standard tableau, A=0, key repeats):** [ ] confirmed [ ] other: _____
- **OTP (slide 17 is inconsistent: 25-letter I/J-merged vs 26-letter):** [ ] 25-letter [ ] 26-letter [ ] ask lecturer

4. Generated Playfair and columnar answers to check

Slot	Key	Plaintext	Ciphertext / answer	Convention used
Q2b	REDFOX	REVIEW ACCESS PERMISSIONS	EDEPDVBGAFNCTQDEHKNCPLRTNC	I/J merge, X padding, 13 pairs
Q4b	REDFOX	CONTAINER SECURITY CHECKS	GFPNIPPRFNFARXMPFLIRBLNC	I/J merge, X padding, 12 pairs
Q5b	4 (3x4)	LOGIN AUDIT	ct LNIOATGUXIDX; answer LOGINAUDIT	3 rows x 4 cols, fill rows, read columns, pad X

Full working: generated_answers.pdf. The 3x4 columnar convention is verified against lecture slides 20-21/24; Playfair has no lecture slide. See slide_convention_report.md.

5. Comments

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